

ICMP Flood Attack

◆ Definition:

An **ICMP Flood Attack** is a type of **Denial of Service (DoS)** attack in which an attacker sends a large number of ICMP (ping) requests to a target system, making it slow or unavailable.

◆ ICMP:

- ICMP stands for **Internet Control Message Protocol**
 - It is used for **network testing and communication** (e.g., ping)
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◆ Working:

1. Attacker sends massive number of **ICMP echo requests (ping)**
 2. Target system replies to each request
 3. System resources (CPU, bandwidth) get exhausted
 4. System becomes **slow or crashes**
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◆ Effects:

- Network congestion
 - High CPU usage
 - Server becomes unavailable
 - Denial of service to legitimate users
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◆ Prevention:

- Limit ICMP traffic (rate limiting)
 - Use firewall to block unnecessary ICMP requests
 - Disable ICMP if not required
 - Use Intrusion Detection System (IDS)
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◆ Conclusion:

ICMP Flood Attack overwhelms a system by sending excessive ping requests, leading to denial of service.